OLIVER HARMAN

(C.V. ABRIDGED)

Research Officer in Economic Geography and Spatial Economics
Department of Geography and Environment & Global School of Sustainability,
London School of Economics and Political Science

Lecturer in Urban Economics
Africa Urban Lab, African School of Economics, Zanzibar

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RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Urban and regional economics; political economy of development; global value chains and foreign direct investment. **Secondary:** Fiscal decentralisation and local public finance; economic geography; computational measurement of institutions. **Regions:** Sub-Saharan Africa, South Asia.

EDUCATION

2021– **University of Oxford**, DPhil Sustainable Urban Development.
Thesis: *Power and Place: Decentralisation, Urbanisation and Local Economic Development in Africa.*
Supervisor: Professor Vlad Mykhnenko.

2014 **London School of Economics and Political Science**, MSc Local Economic Development – *Merit*

2012 **University of Manchester**, BSc (Hons) International Business, Finance and Economics – *First Class Honours*

APPOINTMENTS

2026– **Research Officer in Economic Geography and Spatial Economics**, Department of Geography and Environment & Global School of Sustainability, London School of Economics and Political Science, U.K.

2024– **Lecturer in Urban Economics**, Africa Urban Lab, African School of Economics, Zanzibar, Tanzania

2023– **Research Affiliate**, Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford, U.K.

2022– **Doctoral Affiliate**, Centre for the Study of African Economies (CSAE), University of Oxford, U.K.

2024–2026 **Senior Policy Economist**, International Growth Centre (IGC), Department of Economics, London School of Economics and Political Science, U.K.

2018–2023 **Cities Economist**, International Growth Centre (IGC), Blavatnik School of Government, University of Oxford, U.K.

2017–2018 **Senior Economist & Overseas Development Institute (ODI) Fellow**, Ministry of Communities, Co-operative Republic of Guyana

PUBLICATIONS

Books

- Crescenzi, R., & Harman, O. (2023). *Harnessing Global Value Chains for Regional Development: How to Upgrade through Regional Policy, FDI and Trade.* Regional Studies Policy Impact Book Series. Routledge.
- Crescenzi, R., & Harman, O. (2026). *Green Global Value Chains for Sustainable Development: Environmental Upgrading in a Fragmented Spatial Economy.* Elements on Globalization and Global Supply Chains. Cambridge University Press. In Press (October 2026). Open Access.

Book Chapters

- Crescenzi, R., & Harman, O. (2026). Local and regional development. In V. De Marchi, R. Rabellotti & A. van Assche (Eds.), *Encyclopedia of Global Value Chains.* Edward Elgar.
- Crescenzi, R., & Harman, O. (2023). From local regions in the EU to those in Ukraine (and back again): How FDI and global value chains tie our local economies together. In Y. Gorodnichenko & V. Rashkovan (Eds.), *Supporting Ukraine: More Critical Than Ever* (Ch. 24). CEPR Press.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Berland, O., Harman, O., & Moreau-Kastler, N. (2026). *Unequal Progress and Barriers for Women in Economics.* Reviews of Economic Literature, 1. Stanford University Press. doi:10.21627/aekcyv04

WORKING PAPERS AND WORK IN PROGRESS

- *Status without Power: The Political Economy of Administrative Unit Creation in Uganda.* Working paper.
- *Authority without Means: Partisan Alignment and Central Investment after Guyana's Local Government Reforms.* Working paper, October 2026.
- Harman, O., Hayward, J., & Sampó, G. *Measuring Metropolitan Authority in Africa: A Regional Authority Index for Five Countries, 1994–2024.* IGC Working Paper, in preparation.
- Alvarez-Vilanova, J., Crescenzi, R., Harman, O., & Lippitsch, C. *Green Foreign Direct Investment in Africa.* In preparation.
- Harman, O., & Shukla, R. *Transforming SME Integration into Global Value Chains.* In preparation.
- Franklin, S., Harman, O., Kakoulaki, G., Molla, K., & Read, M. *Degree of Urbanisation in Ethiopia.* In preparation.

SELECTED POLICY PAPERS AND REPORTS

- Crescenzi, R., & Harman, O. (2026). *Upgrading through Global Value Chains and Foreign Investment as a Pathway to Structural Transformation in Zanzibar.* Policy paper.
- Franklin, S., Harman, O., Tilahun Mengistu, S., & Molla, K. *Understanding the Urbanisation Impacts of Ethiopia's Land and Property Tax Reform: A Scoping Study.* IGC Working Paper.
- Delbridge, V., Glaeser, E., Harman, O., Joshi, M., & Spence, E. (2025). *Creating Cleaner Cities: Policy Options for Solid Waste Management.* IGC Synthesis Paper.
- Ratra, V., Harman, O., Bhimsaria, S., & Dobermann, T. (2025). *Urbanisation, Rural Development and Migration.* IGC India Evidence Paper.
- Delbridge, V., Harman, O., Oliveira-Cunha, J., & Venables, A.J. (2022). *Sustainable Urbanisation in Developing Countries: Cities as Places to Innovate, Trade and Work.* IGC Growth Brief.
- Otunola, B., Harman, O., & Kriticos, S. (2019). *The BRT and the Danfo: A Study of Lagos' Transport Reforms from 1999–2019.* IGC Cities that Work Case Study.

Twenty further policy papers, briefs and case studies for the IGC, UNHabitat, the European Commission and national governments are listed in the full CV.

RESEARCH GRANTS AND FUNDED PROJECTS

2025 **Green Foreign Direct Investment in Africa**, with J. Alvarez-Vilanova, R. Crescenzi and C. Lippitsch. >GB£15k

2025 **Authority in African Cities**, International Growth Centre (Co-Investigator). >GB£10k

2025 **RSA Research Network on Green(ing) Global Value Chains for Sustainable Regional Development**, with V. De Marchi, R. Crescenzi and C. Hulke. >GB£10k

2024 **Urban Expansion and Drivers of Emissions in Cities**, with S. Barzin and C. Riom. >GB£15k

2023 **Spatial Vulnerabilities in Punjab**, with G. Bryan, H. Shaikh and N. Tsivanidis. >GB£15k

2021 **Thematic Lead, Cities Research**, Transformative Economic Policy Programme, Bangladesh. FCDO. Programme value >GB£2.25m

2018–2020 **Focal Point**, Global Future Cities Programme (19 cities, FCDO) and Enhancing the Financial Position of Cities Programme (Phases 2 and 3, European Commission), both with UNHabitat. >GB£200,000 and >US$200,000

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

2026 *Still Too Early—or Too Slow? Urbanisation and Unequal Public Goods in African Cities.* CSAE Conference, University of Oxford.

2025 *Authority in African Cities.* Sustainable Urban Development Seminar, University of Oxford.

2025 *Urban Government Capacity and Decentralisation Hotspots in Africa.* CSAE Conference, University of Oxford.

2024 *Urban Government Capacity and Decentralisation Hotspots in Africa.* ODI Global, Public Financial Management Workshop, London.

2023 *Green Global Value Chains for Sustainable Regional Development* (Opening Plenary). Regional Studies Association Summer Conference, Ljubljana.

2020 *Spatial Productivity for Regional and Local Development.* OECD Spatial Productivity Lab, Trento.

TEACHING

2024–2026 **Lecturer in Urban Economics and Module Co-Creator**, 'Urban Economics', Professional Diploma, Africa Urban Lab, African School of Economics, Zanzibar

2024 **Course Co-Convener and Co-Host**, 'BREAD–IGC Virtual PhD Course on Urban Economics' (with Prof. Edward Glaeser)

2024–2026 **Guest Teacher**, 'The Economics of Cities' (GY210), BSc Years 2 and 3, Department of Geography and Environment, LSE

2023–2025 **Seminar Leader**, 'Using Economics in Government', BSc Year 3, School of Politics and Economics, King's College London

2024 **Guest Lecturer**, 'Sustainable Urban Development', MSc, Department of Continuing Education, University of Oxford

AWARDS AND HONOURS

2026 Class Teacher Award (Student Support), Department of Geography and Environment, LSE

2025 Nominated, Outstanding Teacher of the Year, LSE Students' Union

2021–2027 Clarendon Fund Scholarship, University of Oxford (top 0.05% of applicants) >GB£50,000

2020 Award for Excellence, University of Oxford. Nominated and presented by Prof. Sir Paul Collier >GB£1,000

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

2019– **Co-organiser**, Urbanisation and Poverty Reduction Conference (6th–9th editions), with the World Bank and George Washington University

2025 **Organising Committee**, Winter School on Urban and Regional Economics in Africa, University of Cape Town, with ERSA, IGC and the World Bank

2024 **Pre-scoping contributor**, IPCC Special Report on Climate Change and Cities

2020– **Referee**: *Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society*; *Economic Development Quarterly*; *Environment and Urbanization*; *Journal of Economic Geography*; *Spatial Economic Analysis*; Elgar; Routledge; Regional Studies Association; C40 Cities; International Centre for Tax and Development; International Growth Centre

FIELDWORK, LANGUAGES AND IMPACT

Fieldwork: Guyana (2016–18, resident); Ethiopia (2023–25); Uganda; Senegal; Somaliland; Malawi; Zanzibar and Tanzania (2025–26). **Languages:** English (native); French (CEFR B1). **Policy impact:** sixty-one externally validated instances of research internalisation with decision-makers across twenty-seven countries and four international organisations; full register in the extended CV. **References:** available on request.